

Contributions Report

Translation Handbook (دليل الترجمة)

First edition

Prepared for the supervisor of the Translation Team

Translation Team, Guild Professional Club

September 2026

1. Summary

This report explains how each member's material was used in the handbook, what I changed, what I left out and why. A point-by-point record is kept in the Appendix: The Team's Documents, for anyone who wants the detail.

Member	Material	Where it is used	How much was used
Samiuallah Mohammad	First draft; plan and recommendations; Text Analysis Model; terminology selection (with Masooma)	Most chapters, the chapter order, Chapters 17 and 25	Draft: 156 of 175 points. Plan: 21 of 38 requests done, 7 in part, 4 done and later removed, 6 not done. Model: used in full, in simpler form.
Masooma Almesri	Terminology chapter (selected with Samiuallah)	Chapter 21	25 of 43 points
Loulwah Saeed	Audiovisual translation notes (Intro to AVT, AVT 2)	Chapters 26 and 27	43 of 62 points
Shaikhah Alkhaledi	My study notes; structure, editing, covers, layout, website	12 chapters (see Section 6)	All

2. How I decided what to keep

The handbook is for students who have never studied translation, so I asked the same question of every point: does a beginner need this, and is it correct? In practice this meant that:

- each idea is explained with an example before it is given a name;
- each topic appears once, in the chapter where it belongs, even when several documents covered it;
- anything I could not check was taken out rather than printed;
- examples that took a political or religious position were rewritten or dropped;
- history and specialist theory were cut to keep the book under 100 pages;
- every idea taken from a published work is cited, with the author's name in brackets only.

3. Samiuallah Mohammad

3.1 First draft

The draft gave the book its scope, and most of it is in the handbook in rewritten form: the definitions, the differences between English and Arabic, form and meaning, types of meaning, context, collocation, idioms, equivalence, literal and free translation, metaphor, the strategies, cultural approximation, descriptive translation, lexical creation, text analysis with the KUNA example, commentary, post-editing and many of the exercise items.

I merged topics that appeared in more than one place and wrote the empty sections (terminology, machine translation, the glossary and the references). I also corrected some errors, for example the Arabic given for “died”, the translation of “kick the bucket” and “mark my words”, “Bush’s puppy” (the press said “poodle”), the rule on Arabic word order, and two examples translated wrongly (*the cake* given as التفاحة, and *the Home Office* as a minister rather than a ministry). Colloquial Arabic was replaced with formal Arabic.

I left out 51 items. Some were wrong or unclear (“Principles = Foundations”, “mule” as a synonym of “horse”) and would confuse a beginner. The figure of “74 fields” for the Jordanian academy could not be confirmed. A few examples were not neutral, such as a news agency described as biased, or a Qur’anic verse offered as the equivalent of an English proverb. The invented words (tribocracy, puppycracy) are not real English. Some exercise items were dropped only for space and could be used in a later exercise set.

3.2 Plan and recommendations

Most of the plan was followed: the order from easy to hard, the missing strategies and types of translation, the seven procedures, the tips at the start, and the chapters on analysis, commentary, dictionaries, terminology, machine translation, genres, common mistakes and the risk matrix.

Some requests were only partly met. The glossary covers the terms listed at the end of each chapter but not every term mentioned in the text. News is taught through headlines rather than a full article, and the relational model appears as three practical questions in Chapter 19. The practice section, the checklists and the note on future editions were written and later removed (Section 7). Six requests could not be done because the material never reached me: the examples from “the book”, the 180, 182, 386 and Analysis texts, the text الترجمة: ماهيتها and Dr Abdullah’s framework.

3.3 Text Analysis Model

The whole model is used. Chapter 17 now follows its two levels, linguistic (micro and macro) and external, and Chapter 25 asks students to go back to their analysis when writing the commentary. The source the model is based on, Fairclough (2003), was added to the references. I left out terms such as blending, clipping, frame-modification, re-modelling, Al-ta’reed, monitoring, and intrinsic and extrinsic managing, which are too advanced for a first handbook.

4. Masooma Almesri

Chapter 21 is built on the terminology chapter. It keeps the definition of terminology, the difference between a translator and a terminologist, why terms need to be managed, short forms, what makes a good term, the Arabic language academies, how to translate a term, term lists, termbases, and the rule of one term for one idea.

I corrected the definition of a terminologist and a few historical details, then cut the history and schools of terminology, the categories of terms, most of the nine naming rules and the standardisation bodies, since beginners do not need them. The academies’ detailed methods were removed because I could not find a source for them. Because the chapter cited no

sources, I added them, together with UNTERM, Arabterm, a sample term list and medical examples.

5. Loulwah Saeed

Chapters 26 and 27 come mainly from the audiovisual translation notes: why the field matters, its main types, dubbing, the idea that purpose comes first, subtitles, the link between words, images and sound, language variety, cultural references, subtitling strategies and taboo language.

I merged the two lists of subtitling strategies into one, corrected the spelling of Vermeer, Díaz Cintas and Remael, and changed the line length to the usual 37 to 39 characters (up to 42 on streaming platforms). The history of the field, three of the four theories, the summary on the Arab world and the YouTube links were not used: the theory goes beyond what a beginner needs, and links stop working in print. I added subtitle timing, subtitles for the deaf and hard of hearing, a five-step method, a worked example and rules for Arabic subtitles.

The notes on machine translation and dictionaries and the Principles of Translation notes did not reach me, so Chapters 10, 13, 20 and 22 were written from published sources.

6. My own part

I planned the structure (9 parts, 27 chapters), rewrote every chapter as a guided lesson, wrote the opening section for complete beginners, and proofread the whole book twice. My study notes went into Chapters 1, 3, 5, 6, 7, 8, 13, 16, 18, 21, 22 and 26, for example the three kinds of translation, the verbs *be*, *do* and *have*, problems with single words, idioms, news headlines, CAT tools, localisation and the Arabic dubbing of *The Simpsons*. Where the team's material had gaps, I added sections from published sources, among them the seven procedures, communicative translation, explicitation and implicitation, genres, dictionaries, common mistakes and the risk matrix. I also designed the two covers, the layout, the QR code and the team's website.

7. What I removed, and why

Removed	Reason
Practice section and answer key	Too long for a handbook; each chapter still ends with questions and answers.
The four checklists	They repeated the chapter summaries.
Note on future editions	Not needed in a first edition.
Scholars' names in the text	Easier to read; the citations in brackets remain.
References to the course and the lecturer	The handbook is meant to be used on its own.
Part descriptions and about a third of the text	Repetition and long explanations made the pages heavy.
Concepts repeated from my notes	Each concept appears once; the examples were kept.

Removed	Reason
Placeholders, the empty Dr Abdullah checklist, unconfirmed reviewers and the Guild Season	Not final or not confirmed.

8. My view

The team's documents covered nearly everything the handbook needed. The draft followed the syllabus closely, and the terminology and audiovisual notes were detailed. What they needed was correction, shortening and a single order. The draft repeated itself, some examples were inaccurate and several claims had no source, while the specialist notes were written at a level above a beginner. Most of my work went into fixing these points and filling the gaps.

In my opinion the handbook is ready for a final read by a native Arabic specialist, and for the supervisor's approval once the points below and those in Section 7 of the Final Report are settled.

9. Still to confirm

- Names and roles on the Contributors list (page iv).
- That the audiovisual notes are Loulwah's.
- Whether Samiuallah Mohammad should be listed under supervision.
- Any member not yet listed, and their contribution.
- Whether the material not yet received should go into this edition.